

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a newspaper article about eye colour and Asia's definition of beauty:

Blue eyes – an ideal form of beauty?

Of all the different eye colours, blue appears to be the most desirable as there is a popular belief that people with blue eyes are considered 'good-looking'. To cater to this desire, there are contact lenses in different colours (like green and blue) to allow people to have an eye colour of their choice. Coloured contact lenses are popular in many parts of Asia, especially in Japan and Korea, where it is not uncommon to see girls with dyed blonde hair wearing blue contact lenses.

According to the International Society of Aesthetic Plastic Surgeons, South Korea has the highest cosmetic surgery statistics in the world, including eye surgery to make people's eyes larger. This has caused debates as to whether Asians believe that Caucasian eyes are more beautiful. Some say that Asians are just trying to conform to a global beauty standard, whilst others argue that Asians are striving to appear more Caucasian, since they see this as an ideal form of beauty.

Now, it seems that a doctor in America is able to permanently change the colour of one's eyes – from brown to blue! Using a laser treatment lasting only 20 seconds, the laser energy is absorbed by the eye's brown pigment, causing the pigment tissue to change, effectively changing brown eyes to blue within two to three weeks. This procedure is pending approval and costs US\$5,000.

Your group wants to discuss whether Western forms of beauty should be considered the ideal form of beauty. You may want to talk about:

- popular beliefs about what is considered good-looking for men and women
- whether the colour of one's eyes is an important criterion in being considered good-looking
- whether or not Western forms of beauty should be considered the ideal
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like your eye colour?
2. Would you wear coloured contact lenses, such as green or purple?
3. Would you want to change your eye colour?
4. What would you say to a friend who was thinking of changing their eye colour?
5. If you permanently changed your eyes to blue, how would your family feel?
6. Should Asians be criticised for wanting to look Westernised?
7. Do you think the procedure to change one's eye colour would be popular in Asia?
8. Do you feel pressure to conform to a Westernised form of beauty?